

Ethical Considerations

Section Introduction

In order to protect the rights, privacy, and safety of everyone involved especially the faculty, staff, and administrators of PUP Unisan, Quezon Campus, whose input was essential for creating the research monitoring system this section addresses the ethical principles that were followed during the study's conduct. The researchers understand that upholding the integrity of the research process and the institution's trust depends heavily on responsible behavior.

Informed Consent

The goals of the study, the methods for collecting data (such as surveys and interviews), the possible risks, and the expected advantages of creating the Research Monitoring System were all explained in detail to the participants. Participation was entirely voluntary. Each participant gave their informed consent before any data was collected. Participants had to digitally or in person sign a consent form outlining their rights and the parameters of the study before any data could be collected.

Confidentiality and Anonymity

All responses and identifying information were handled with strict confidentiality by the researchers. No personally identifiable information (PII) was gathered from survey or interview participants in order to protect their privacy. To separate responses from identity, participant data was coded (Participant A, Participant B) when needed. To ensure the highest level of data protection, all digital records of the gathered data are safely kept on a password-protected, encrypted repository that is only accessible by the research team.

Voluntary Participation and Right to Withdraw

All prospective participants were made acutely aware that their participation was entirely voluntary. Respondents were made fully aware that they were not subject to any coercion or pressure to participate, and that their choice to do so would not have an impact on their standing or relationship with the researchers or the institution. Additionally, participants were free to leave the study at any moment without giving a reason or incurring any penalties or negative repercussions.

Minimization of Risk

Participants in the study have minimal risk. Answering a standard survey questionnaire and conducting interviews about current research monitoring procedures and their experiences with possible system features were the main methods used to gather data. By avoiding intrusive or sensitive questions and guaranteeing secure data transmission protocols, precautions were taken to guarantee participants' psychological, emotional, and digital safety.

Ethical Treatment in System Development

Particular ethical issues pertaining to system design were taken into account because the project entails the creation of a Research Monitoring with Data Analytics System. Features that guarantee the safe handling and storage of institutional research data were incorporated into the system's design. During system testing, data misuse was strictly prevented by only using dummy or anonymized data when necessary. The researchers used encryption and access controls to guarantee complete compliance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012. Additionally, in order to ensure that the data used for performance monitoring and insights is accurate, documented, and devoid of biased metrics, the analytics component of the system was developed with a commitment to fairness and avoidance of algorithmic bias.

Permissions and Approvals

The researchers obtained the required official approvals before beginning any data collection. This included:

- Approval from the research adviser to guarantee the methodology's soundness.
- Approval for ethical supervision and clearance from the campus research coordinator. Official authorization from the PUP Unisan, Quezon Campus Administration to carry out the research, disseminate questionnaires, and interview staff members.

Data Handling, Storage, and Disposal

All information gathered, including consent forms and system-related paperwork, will be safely kept for as long as is necessary for institutional and academic documentation. Throughout this time, access to the data will remain restricted. All data, both digital and physical, will be securely and permanently erased or disposed of to prevent future

unauthorized access after the study's final completion and defense, as well as after the institution's mandated retention period. This will complete the data lifecycle responsibly.

Ethical Compliance Statement

The researchers strictly followed the ethical standards that were already in place, the rules of the institution (PUP Unisan, Quezon Campus), and the laws of the country that were relevant during the study.